



07 | How to Support Me: Needs & Triggers



Not a reader? Listen to the “Deep Dive” by NoteBookLM

[attachment:91515ed2-389e-48a5-b558-bc38385e99fc:Codys_Guide_to_Understanding_and_Connection_-_07_How_to_Support_Me_Needs_Triggers.wav](#)

7.1 Conditions I Navigate:

- ADHD (executive dysfunction, hyperfocus, forgetfulness)
- PTSD (from past trauma — be mindful of sudden tones or criticism)
- Depression & Anxiety (daily management, not always visible)
- Phonophobia (sensitivity to noise — headphones are survival)
- Sleep Disorders (wake-up routines take planning)

7.2 What Helps:

- Clarity, calm tone, nonjudgmental check-ins
- Visual aids, task breakdowns, async options
- Grace for forgetfulness — it’s rarely about carelessness



Based on Cody's manual, here's how their conditions shape their interactions and needs:

ADHD Impact:

- Experiences executive dysfunction and hyperfocus, which affects their ability to manage tasks and time
- Needs visual aids and task breakdowns to process information effectively
- May forget things, which should be met with understanding rather than judgment

PTSD Considerations:

- Particularly sensitive to sudden tones and criticism
- Benefits from calm, nonjudgmental communication approaches

Additional Sensory & Mental Health Needs:

- Manages ongoing depression and anxiety that may not be externally apparent
- Has phonophobia requiring headphones as a coping mechanism
- Requires structured wake-up routines due to sleep disorders

Best Ways to Support:

- Provide clear communication with a calm tone
- Offer asynchronous options for interaction
- Show understanding about forgetfulness rather than assuming carelessness